



Logo guidelines

Version 2.0 · September 2026

Draft: waiting for the founder's own edits and the parent blind check. Not yet adopted.

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THE IDEA

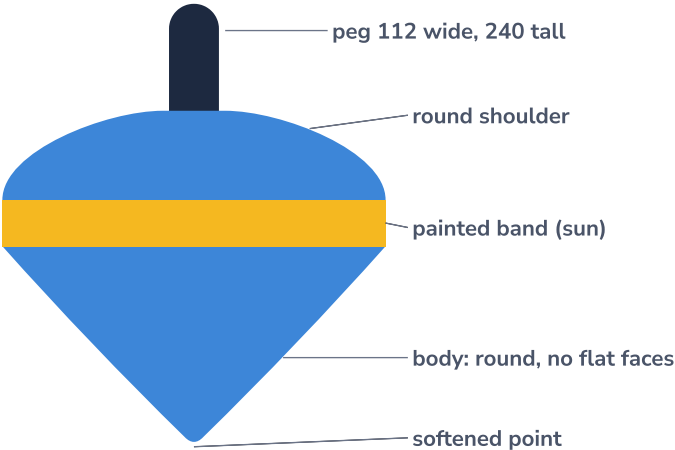
The Maker's Seal

Our logo is a maker's seal, like the stamp pressed into the bottom of a good wooden toy, with our name around the edge and a spinning top in the middle.

A top is one of the oldest toys there is and needs nothing but a child's hand, which is the whole idea: play comes first.

The name is part of the mark, so it never has to be decoded, and the only letters anywhere are the words of the name. The top is a toy, not an initial.

PART	UNITS (SEAL RADIUS 500)	NOTES
Ring lettering	caps 96, 56 from the edge, 40 clear of the top	Bricolage Grotesque 800, optical size 24. Caps 1.54 mm at the 16 mm minimum.
Two balls	radius 29	Tomato, one in each gap between the words.
The top	half-width 430, band 104, shoulder 200, body 450, peg 112 × 240	Sky body, sun band, paper peg. Fills 82% of the middle and leans 8° in the seal (the favicon always stands upright).



WHAT TO USE WHERE

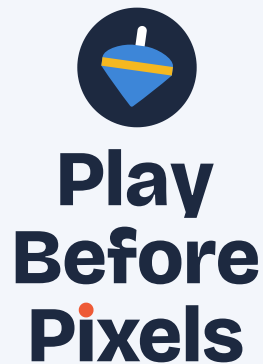
The logo family



Horizontal lockup · the default. Site header, letterhead, email, hang tags. The small seal carries no words, so the name appears once.



Seal (mark.svg, left) · avatars at 80 px and up, stickers, book spines and back covers, merch. **Small seal** (mark-small.svg, right) · the same seal without words, for anything under 80 px or 16 mm.



Stacked lockup · square spaces: tote fronts, sticker sheets, the About page.

Play Before Pixels

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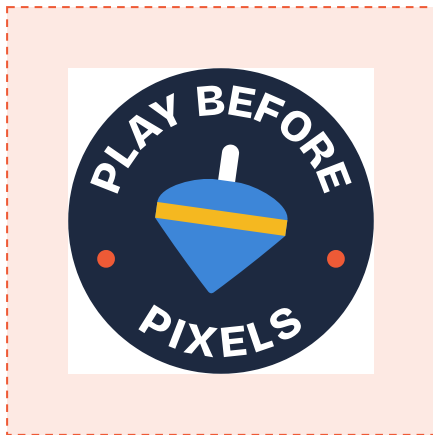
Wordmark · where a seal will not fit: footers, spines, labels. The **small cut** (below) opens the letters up for anything under 25 mm wide.

The favicon is the top alone, redrawn on a 16-pixel grid (page 7). Nowhere else does the top appear without its disc.

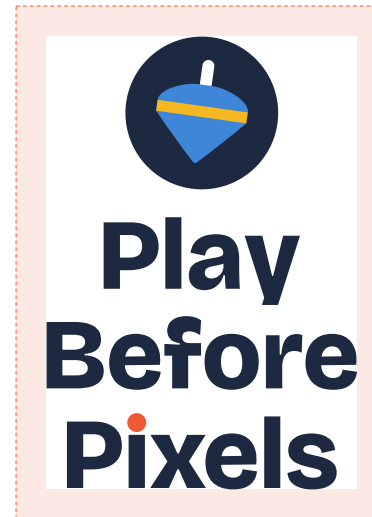
ROOM TO BREATHE

Clear space

Keep the shaded zone clear of text, edges, other logos and busy photo detail. **With a seal:** one fifth of the seal's diameter all round (in the lockups, one fifth of the small seal). **Wordmark alone:** half the height of its capital P. The files are cropped to the artwork, so add this space yourself.



Seal



Stacked lockup



Horizontal lockup



Wordmark

SMALL, NOT SMALLER

Minimum sizes

VERSION	SCREEN	PRINT	EMBROIDERY	STAMP / VINYL
Seal with words (mark)	80 px	16 mm	60 mm	20 mm
Small seal, no words (mark-small)	16 px	6 mm	25 mm	8 mm
Horizontal lockup	160 px wide	35 mm wide	90 mm wide	40 mm wide
Stacked lockup	100 px wide	22 mm wide	60 mm wide	25 mm wide
Wordmark	120 px wide	25 mm wide	90 mm wide	35 mm wide
Wordmark, small cut	not for screens	15–25 mm wide	—	15 mm wide
Favicon (the top alone)	16 px	—	—	—

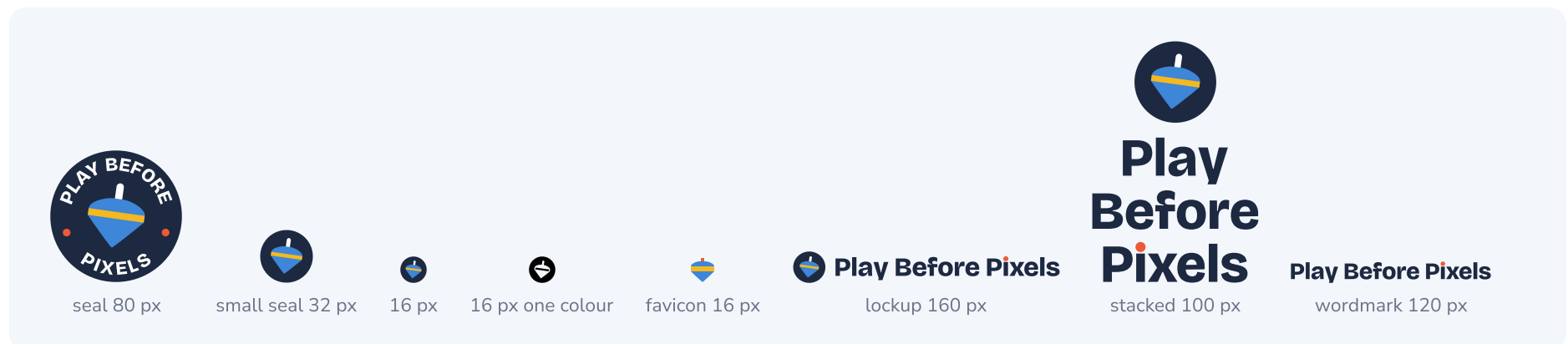
Seal with words: 80 px on screen, 16 mm in print. At 16 mm the capitals are 1.54 mm tall, safely above the 1.2 mm print limit. Anything smaller uses the small seal.

Embroidery: the seal with words from 60 mm (5.8 mm capitals); ask the embroiderer to check the letter gaps. The small seal from 25 mm. One-colour stitching uses the black or white files, which keep the band as a stencil stripe.

Small cut of the wordmark: Bricolage's optical size 14, tracking +30, word space 226, so the heavy letters do not fill in on spines and labels.

Rebuilding prints the smallest gaps at every one of these sizes, so an edit that closes a gap shows at once.

ACTUAL SIZE ON SCREEN (96 DPI)



COLOUR

Colour versions

● Ink #1D2940
● Sky #3D86D8
● Sun (band) #F5B820
● Tomato #EE5A36
● Paper #FFFFFF
● Wash #F3F6FB



Full colour · ink disc, paper letters, on paper and light tints



On wash and pale tints



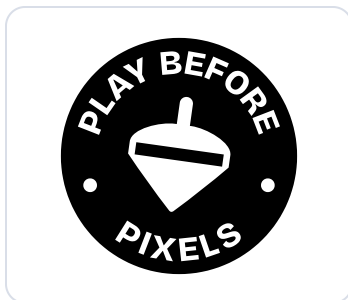
Reverse · on ink: paper disc, ink letters



On sky or tomato: **one-colour white**



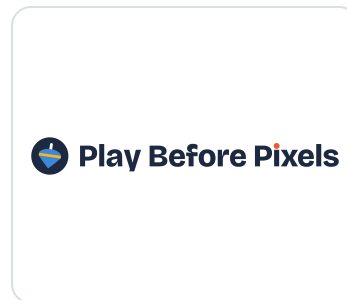
Sticker · white die-cut border for photos and busy grounds



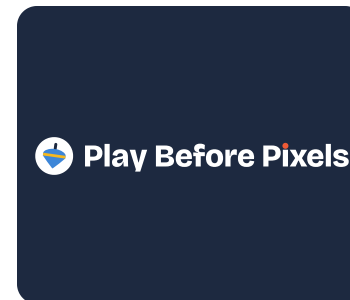
One colour black · stamps, embroidery, vinyl, newsprint



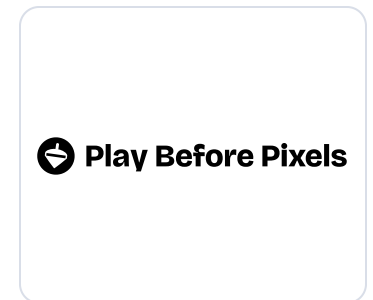
One colour white · dark garments, laser-etch, vinyl



Lockup on paper



Lockup reversed on ink

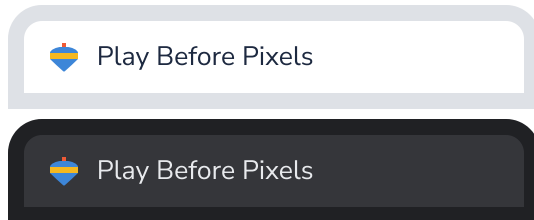


Lockup, one colour

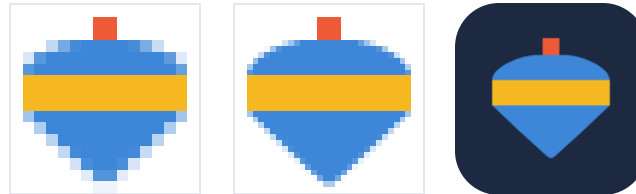
The disc is only ever ink or paper, or black or white in one colour: never sky, tomato, sun yellow or gold. The one-colour files are single even-odd paths: every letter, ball and the top are true holes, and the band is a stencil stripe that stops short of each edge, so the top never falls apart when it is cut from vinyl or stitched.

IN USE

Screens and social



Favicon · the top alone, upright, drawn on a 16-pixel grid: a square tomato peg, a band on whole pixels. Its colours are fixed and each keeps at least 3.4:1 contrast on a white tab and 4.3:1 on a dark tab, so it never disappears. PNG and ICO fallbacks: png/favicon-16/32/48.png, favicon.ico.



16 px and 32 px (enlarged to show the pixels) and the 180 px home-screen icon.



Social avatar (left) · the small seal full bleed, so a round crop lands on its own edge. Where a profile picture shows at 80 px or more, the seal with words (right) may be used instead.



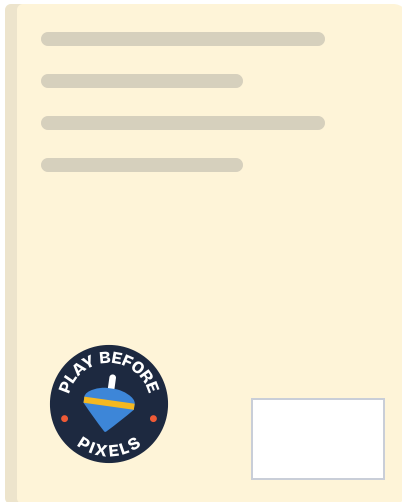
Play Before Pixels

Talk, touch and play come first.

Link preview · og-image-1200x630.png.

PLACEMENT

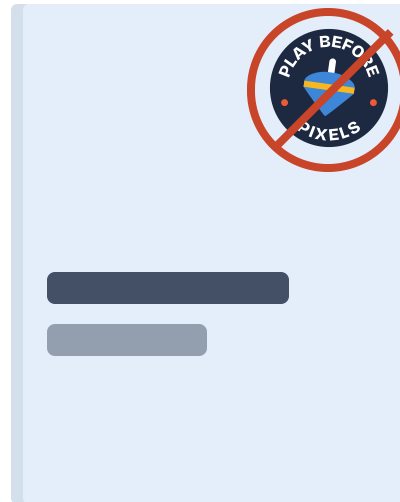
Books and merch



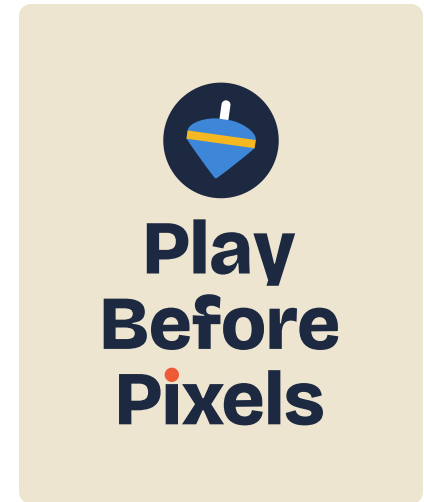
Back cover · the seal at the foot, in the same place on every book, like a publisher's imprint. 16 mm or larger.



Spine · the small seal and the small-cut wordmark reading top to bottom. The seal with words only on spines wide enough for 16 mm.



Never on the front cover, upper right. That is where award medals go. A round seal there can pass for an award, which misleads buyers.



Tote and sticker sheet · the stacked lockup, or the seal on its own. One-colour files for stitching and vinyl.

- Never print the seal in gold, foil or sun yellow, and never add laurels, ribbons, stars or a starburst edge. It is a maker's stamp, not a medal.
- Spine or back cover only on books; on printables, the footer; on merch, wherever the product template puts it.
- Never set the seal and the wordmark side by side: the name would appear twice. The lockups pair the small seal with the name.

KEEP IT THE SAME EVERYWHERE

Do and don't



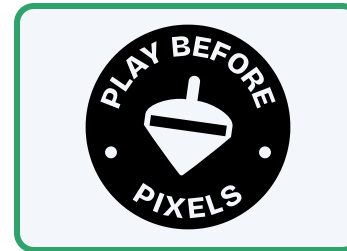
Do · use the supplied files as they are



Do · reverse on ink with the paper disc



Do · use the sticker on photos and patterns



Do · use one colour for stamps, vinyl and stitching



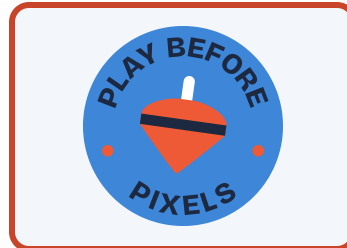
Don't · open up or separate the lettering so it can misread



Don't · stretch, squash or skew



Don't · rotate the seal



Don't · recolour the disc, the top or the letters



Don't · use gold, foil, sun yellow or laurels (award medal)



Don't · draw the top faceted or four-sided, or put letters or symbols on it



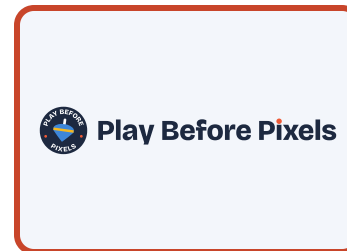
Don't · give the top a face, motion lines or a swoosh



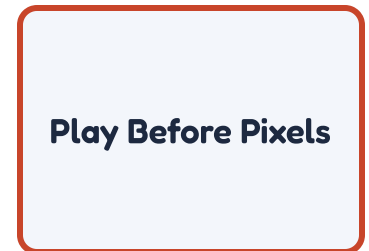
Don't · put an initial on the top or in the disc



Don't · use initials: no PB, BP, PP or pbp



Don't · set the seal beside the wordmark



Don't · retype the name: the wordmark is drawn, not typed

Why no initials. PB reads as PBS, as “peanut butter” (a nut-allergy word in classrooms) and as Pb, the symbol for lead. BP is an oil company. PP is ruled out by BRAND.md. pbp is built from b and p, the mirror-image pair early readers mix up.

THE KIT

Files and next steps

FILE	USE
mark.svg (+ -reverse, -black, -white)	The seal with words
mark-small.svg (+ -reverse, -black, -white)	The small seal, no words
mark-sticker.svg	Die-cut sticker, photos, busy grounds
lockup-horizontal / lockup-stacked (.svg, 4 versions each)	Small seal + name
wordmark.svg, wordmark-small.svg (4 versions each)	The name alone; small cut under 25 mm
favicon.svg · favicon.ico · png/favicon-16/32/48.png	Browser tab
png/apple-touch-icon-180.png	Phone home screen
png/mark-512/1024.png and variants	Marketplace and profile images
png/...-2400.png	Lockups and wordmark, 2400 px wide, transparent
social-avatar-1080.png · og-image-1200x630.png	Social profiles · link previews
src/build.py · src/rebuild.sh	Every file, rebuilt from the numbers at the top of build.py

BEFORE THE LOGO IS ADOPTED

1. The founder makes her own dated edits in src/build.py (the band colour, the lean and at least one choice of her own), rebuilds, and logs each one.
2. Blind check: show blind-test/test-small.png, as a real browser tab, to 5–10 parents who have never seen the brand and ask “what is this?”. Adopt only if most say “spinning top” or “toy” and nobody names a letter.

BEFORE FILING OR PRINTING IN BULK

1. Reverse-image search of mark.svg, mark-small.svg and favicon.svg.
2. USPTO design-code search (toys and tops; circles with lettering, 26.01) in classes 9, 16, 25, 28, 35 and 41, then an attorney’s knockout search.
3. File in AlphaPlay LLC’s name with an attorney as correspondent: the seal with its words, plus the name as a standard-character wordmark. Never the bare top.